



ETHAN SWOPE Associated Press

FIRES RAGE IN BIG SUR AREA

A firetruck passes the Plaskett fire as it burns toward Highway 1 in Big Sur. While firefighters struggle to contain the Timber fire nearby, the Plaskett blaze exploded Friday and Saturday. **CALIFORNIA, B3**

They have a lot to say about AI

Hollywood’s voice actors worry that it’s taking their jobs, and they’re fighting back.

By NILESH CHRISTOPHER

Hollywood’s voice actors — one of the first groups to wrestle with artificial intelligence replacement — are battling one another over how to deal with AI.

Big, established names are using it to make more money. Non-stars say the number of jobs has plummeted and that they are being tricked into training their replacements.

Unions want further restrictions on the technology. Some actors are resisting the urge to create cheap clones to do work, but many nonunion freelancers say they have no choice.

“I’m so afraid,” said Stacy Rivera, 34, a Los Angeles-based voice actor who does work for commercials, Netflix and others and is resisting the temptation to let her voice be used for AI. “I don’t know if what I’m doing now is going to be an option in the next five years.”

Still, AI voices are imperceptibly taking over screens and speakers.

A clone of Michael Caine’s voice narrates the 13-hour audiobook of the “Odyssey.” The British actor has licensed his voice to ElevenLabs, an AI voice company in New York. Matthew McConaughey uses its technology to create a Spanish-language version of his newsletter.

ElevenLabs’ voice marketplace features clones of dozens of personalities — including actress Judy Garland, physicist Richard Feynman and popular characters such as Mr. Potato Head for creators to legally license and get compensated for their use.

Well-known actors are getting millions of dollars to allow their voices to be cloned to become a voice assistant, said David Lawrence XVII, a veteran actor who is part of the SAG-AFTRA audiobook steering committee that approves [See Voice, A1f]

Rare cancer stalks children in O.C. suburb

Six cases of Ewing sarcoma strike Ladera Ranch

By Clara Harter

Seventeen-year-old Brody Matteson went through hell in the last year of his life. Feeding tubes, blood transfusions, ambulance rides, intense nausea and bone-deep pain.

He fought with astonishing courage, drawing on years of grit honed on the football field, but the disease continued to consume him.

Brody died in March after a 20-month battle with Ewing sarcoma — a bone cancer so rare only around 200 children and teens are diagnosed with it across the United States a year, according to the American Cancer Society.

After his diagnosis and death, Brody’s parents received messages from other families in Ladera Ranch whose children had suffered from the same uncommon disease.

Alarm bells started ringing. Members of the Orange County community tallied at least six cases of Ewing sarcoma diagnosed among children and young adults between 2013 and 2024.

“There definitely is cause for concern for members of this community,” said Dr. Janet Yoon, a pediatric hematologist-oncologist at City of Hope who specializes in [See Cancer, A8]



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

BONNIE Regan received this necklace when her son, Ryan, was born. Ryan died last year. “He was our only child, so he was the center of our universe.”

Lawyer of ‘miracles’ drew in immigrants

By ITZEL LUNA



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

SYLVIA VELAZQUEZ says Alexandra Lozano “seemed like a good person who could help me.”

Sylvia Velazquez’s shrine to the Virgin Mary in her South Los Angeles home was once adorned with a mug, pencils and an agenda from Alexandra Lozano’s law firm — an image of Lozano’s long, blond hair, her signature red lipstick and her wide smile stamped on the branded merchandise.

The 57-year-old Mexican immigrant often prayed to the holy figure, asking her to protect Lozano, a famed immigration lawyer whom she had paid \$15,000 to help her get a U.S. visa.

“When I signed my contract with Lozano, I got home and I cried to my *virgencita*,” said Velazquez, who works as a hairdresser out of her home. “This woman seemed like a good person who could help me.”

It all felt like divine intervention, she said, until a few [See Lawyer, A16]

Deal is reached on regulation of data centers

California lawmakers compromise over legislation addressing facilities’ energy use.

By DAKOTA SMITH AND BLANCA BEGERT

SACRAMENTO — After weeks of intense negotiation, state lawmakers on Friday reached a compromise on legislation to regulate energy use by California’s growing data center industry, action triggered by community anger over the facilities and fears of high utility bills in some communities.

The goal, according to legislators and advocates, is to protect consumers from growing electricity costs driven upward by the sprawling facilities and to track the centers’ immense energy and water consumption.

Business groups representing tech companies argued that some of the pro-

posed restrictions and requirements, along with California’s high energy costs and lack of available land, would make it difficult for data centers to open in the state.

Municipalities risk missing out on tax revenues and jobs from the centers if the industry goes elsewhere, they said.

Two bills to regulate the controversial industry consumed the state Legislature in the final weeks of the 2026 session, drawing in Gov. Gavin Newsom and industry organizations and lobbyists representing some of the world’s most influential companies, including Google, Meta, Amazon and artificial intelligence firms such as Anthropic and OpenAI.

Proposed legislation by Sen. Steve Padilla (D-Chula Vista) and Assemblymember Rick Chavez Zbur (D-Los Angeles), finalized Friday, would establish special rules for data centers’ elec- [See Data centers, A7]

Josh Kushner’s road to ownership of the L.A. Lakers

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

When news broke that Mark Walter’s insurance businesses were under federal investigation and that the Lakers and Dodgers owner might be in financial trouble, Josh Kushner sensed a business opportunity.

The New York venture capitalist called former Disney Chief Executive Bob Iger — his partner in a bid for a new Las Vegas NBA franchise — wondering if they might instead snap up Los Angeles’ marquee basketball team.

The two quickly agreed, Kushner contacted Walter and within 72 hours the deal was done to avoid a bidding war. And with that, the younger brother of Jared Kushner, President Trump’s son-in-law, was thrust into a media spotlight he has

largely shunned.

But while Kushner may be relatively unknown compared with his politically active brother, he has rapidly and quietly risen to the upper echelons of business, with an estimated net worth of \$16.7 billion.

His Thrive Capital, which he founded in 2010 while attending Harvard Business School, has more than \$65 billion under management. Its investments include some of the world’s top young companies, including OpenAI, SpaceX and rapidly expanding Southern California defense contractor Anduril.

Kushner declined to be interviewed.

People who work with the investor credit his business acumen, low-key demeanor and daunting work ethic, qualities that have attracted partners, founders and mentors alike — including [See Kushner, A12]

A giant leap in NASA’s search for ‘Earth twins’

Roman telescope will use JPL tech to shed light on the mysteries of the universe.

By NOAH HAGGERTY

NASA is set to launch its latest multibillion-dollar telescope Sunday morning, as scientists gather at Florida’s Space Coast and await liftoff with bated breath.

After riding atop a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket, the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope promises to vastly expand our knowledge of planets beyond the solar system and advance the search for elusive “Earth twins.” The observatory will also help scientists better understand the cosmic tug-of-war between invisible “dark matter” and “dark energy” — a contest whose outcome could either expand or collapse the universe.

Massive teams of engineers and scientists — in-

cluding personnel from Caltech and NASA’s Jet Propulsion Laboratory — have worked for more than a decade to develop the \$4.3-billion telescope. As a member of NASA’s class of “flagship” astrophysics missions, its acclaimed colleagues include the Hubble and James Webb space telescopes.

Roman, named after the woman at NASA who championed the Hubble telescope, will run explorational laps around the 36-year-old observatory. It will view the heavens in the same crisp detail as Hubble, but can survey an area of sky in one year that would take Hubble 1,000 years.

“This truly takes a village,” said Vanessa Bailey, JPL instrument scientist for the coronagraph sensor that will aid in the search for other worlds. “I grew up in rural South Dakota, and the closest town to me had about 2,000 people. There have been more than 2,000 people who have contributed in some way just to the [See Telescope, A16]

Newsom revises fire liability plan

The governor overhauls legislation that would have sent most costs of utility-sparked blazes to insurers. **BUSINESS, A10**

LAPD releases video of beating

Jail footage shows group of officers piling on Jose Carlos Hoyos-Munoz, 58, found dead shortly after. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Politicians in pot scandal sentenced

Ricardo Pacheco gets up to 18 months for bribery, and Isaac Galvan gets 18 months for facilitating bribes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Sunny and warm.
L.A. Basin: 89/68. **B8**

